ANCIENT INDIAN HISTORY

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Gupta Period

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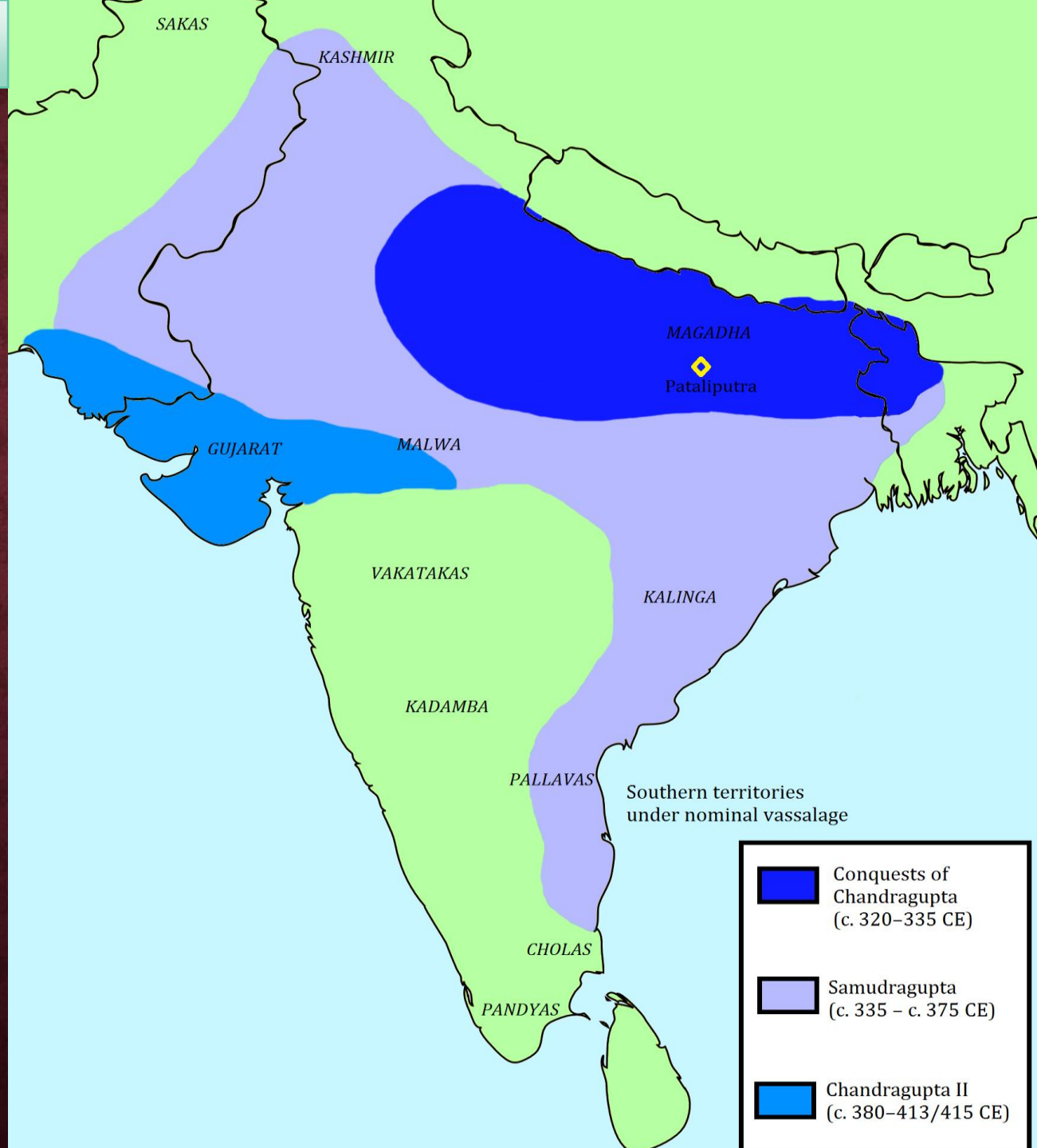
Gupta Empire

‘Golden Age’

- Political Unification
- Mostly centralized government
- Sanskrit literary works
- Stone sculpture and architecture
- Science and Technology
- Mathematics
- Medicine

‘Golden Age?’

- Status of Women
- Varnaashramdharma
- Decline of Trade
- Urban Decay



Sri Gupta (240-80?)

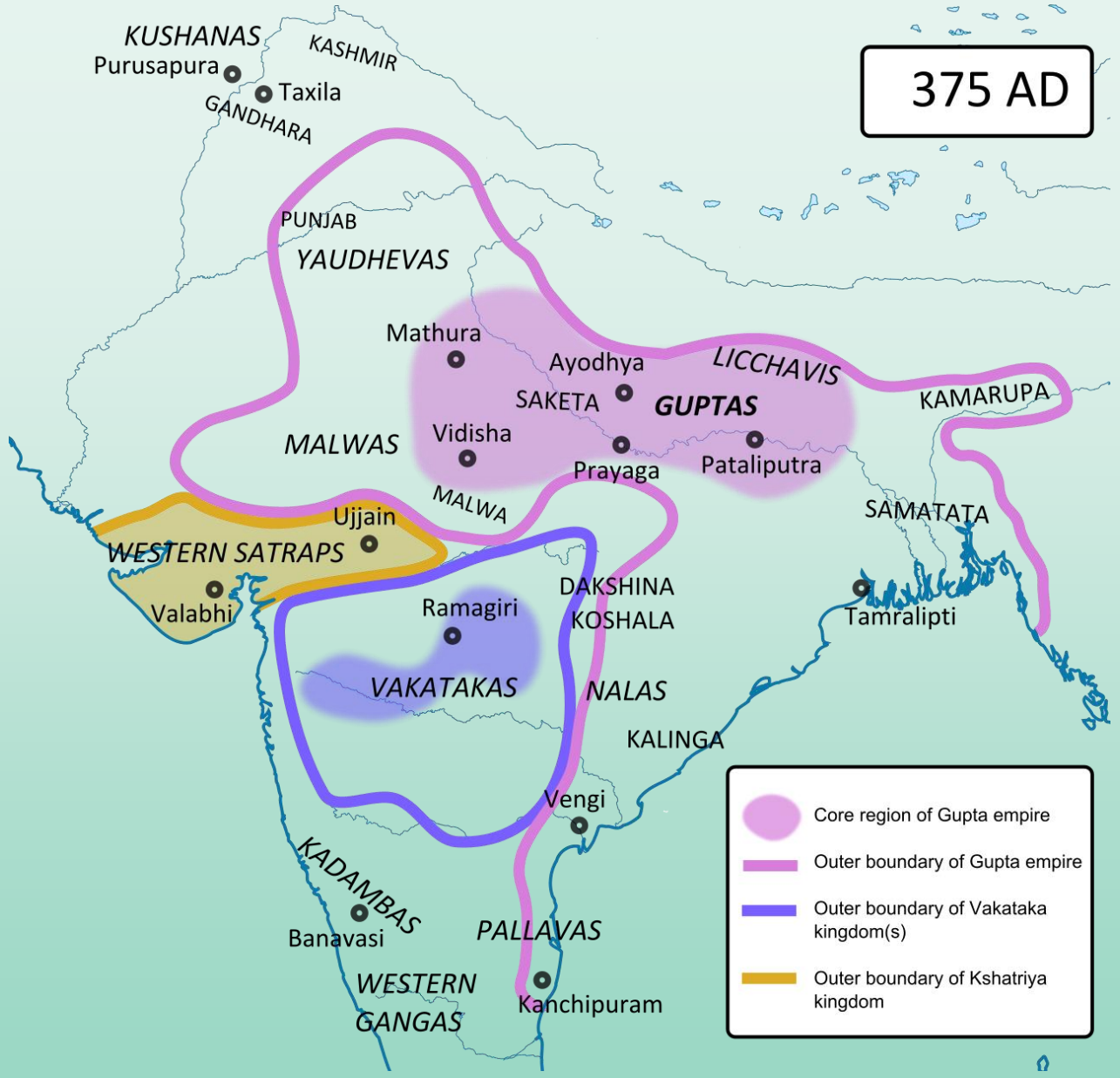
Gupta script inscription *Maharaja Sri Gupta* (("Great King, Lord Gupta"), mentioning the first ruler of the dynasty, king Gupta. Inscription by Samudragupta on the Allahabad pillar, where Samudragupta presents king Gupta as his great-grandfather. Dated circa 350 CE.[38]

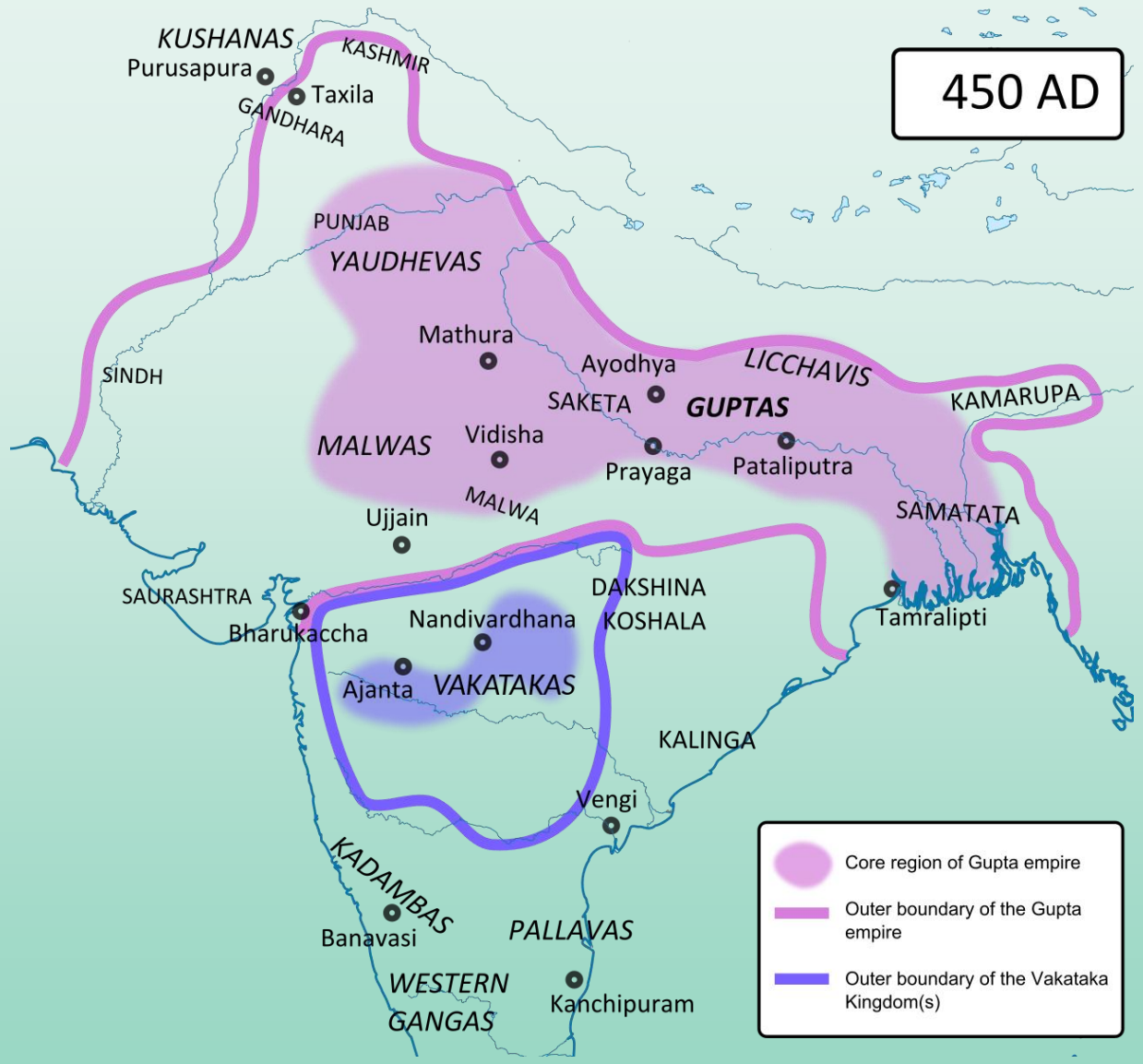
Ghatotkach (280-319?)

Chandragupta-I (319–335/)

Chandragupta I & Kumaradevi

- ✓ Foundations of the Gupta empire
- ✓ *Maharajadhiraja*
- ✓ Gupta era in 319-20
- ✓ Kumaradevi (Lichchhavi)
- ✓ Samudragupta- *Lichchhavi-dauhitra*


375 AD
KUSHANAS
Purusapura
KASHMIR
Taxila
GANDHARA
PUNJAB
YAUDHEVAS
Mathura
Ayodhya
LICCHAVIS
SAKETA
GUPTAS
KAMARUPA
MALWAS
Vidisha
Prayaga
Pataliputra
MALWA
Ujjain
SAMATATA
WESTERN SATRAPS
Valabhi
Ramagiri
DAKSHINA
KOSHALA
Tamralipti
VAKATAKAS
NALAS
KALINGA
Vengi
KADAMBAS
Banavasi
PALLAVAS
WESTERN
GANGAS
Kanchipuram
Core region of Gupta empire
Outer boundary of Gupta empire
Outer boundary of Vakataka kingdom(s)
Outer boundary of Kshatriya kingdom


450 AD
KUSHANAS
Purusapura
KASHMIR
Taxila
GANDHARA
PUNJAB
YAUDHEVAS
SINDH
Mathura
Ayodhya
LICCHAVIS
SAKETA
GUPTAS
KAMARUPA
MALWAS
Vidisha
Prayaga
Pataliputra
MALWA
Ujjain
SAMATATA
SAURASHTRA
Bharukaccha
Nandivardhana
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WESTERN
GANGAS
Kanchipuram
Core region of Gupta empire
Outer boundary of the Gupta empire
Outer boundary of the Vakataka Kingdom(s)

Samudragupta (335–375)

- Known: A policy of war and conquest
- V. A. Smith- ‘Napoleon’ of India

- *Ashvamedha-ashvamedha* coins
- *Anukampavan* (full of compassion)-Ceylon king-Meghavarman, Kaviraja (king among poets)
- Music- playing on the veena (lyre) on occasion (Coin).
- Hindu-other religions-Vasubandhu

Allahabad Pillar (Prayaga prashasti)

- Inscriptions of Ashoka & Jahangir
- Sanskrit by Harisena
  - *Sandhivigrahika* (minister for peace and war)
  - *Mahadandanayaka* (judicial/military officer).

Opponents into four categories

1. Rulers slain, Annexed outright,
2. ‘Frontier’ kings, pay tributes,
3. Rulers defeated, but reinstated as tributaries
4. ‘Distant’ kings, embassies.

- Defeat of 12 South Indian rulers by Samudragupta
  - (including Vishnugopa of Kanchi)
- The policy of political conciliation
- Ceylon-Embassy- privileges-Sinhalese monks at Bodh Gaya
- Tributes from many kings of south-east Asia.

Motivations for Expansion

- **Imperial Ambition:** Samudragupta's primary motivation was to extend and consolidate the Gupta Empire's influence over a vast territory, fulfilling his ambitions of imperial expansion.

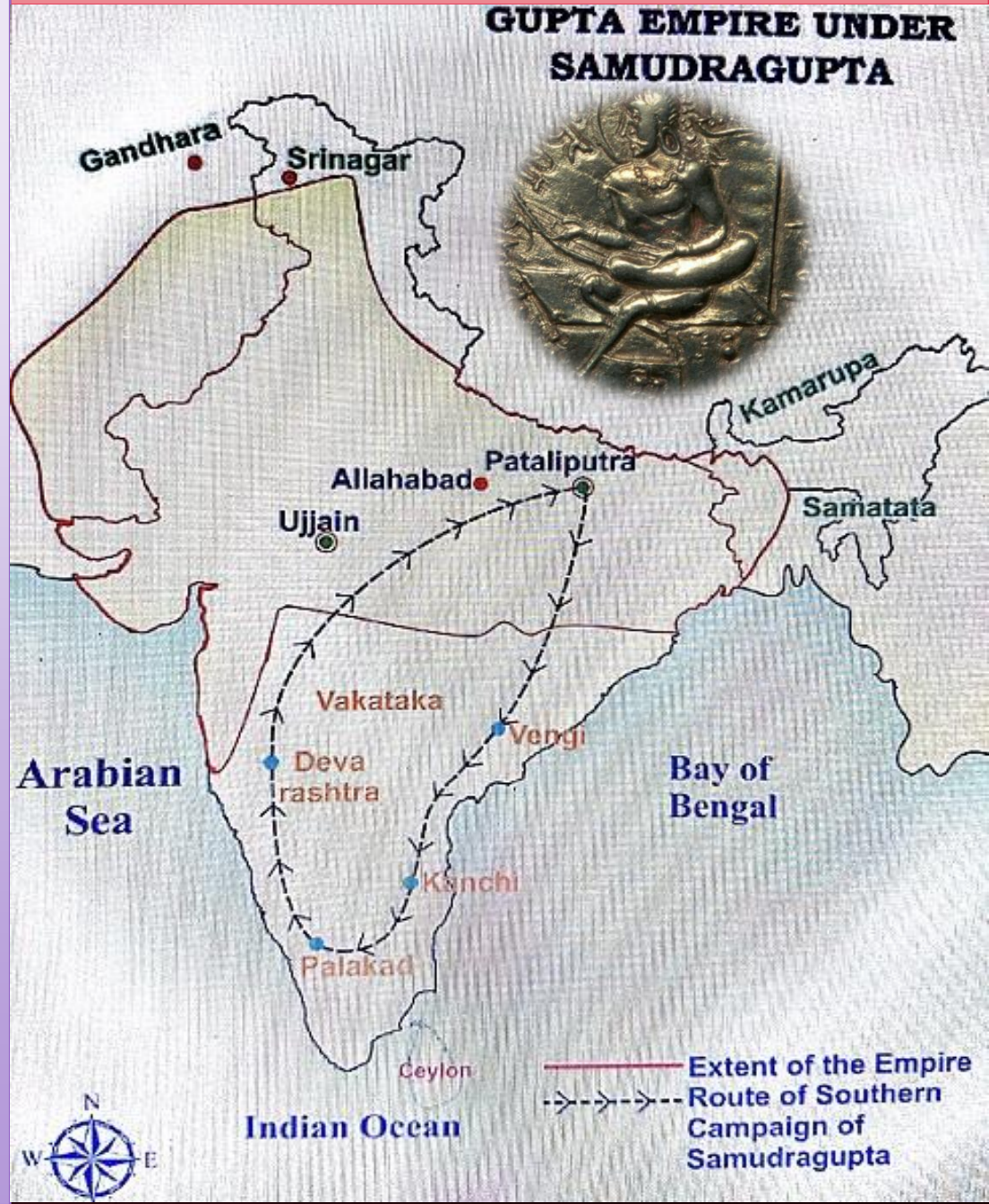
- **Religious and Cultural Factors:** Religious differences, such as conflicts with Shiva-worshipping Nagas, also played a role in some of his military campaigns.

- **Economic Incentives:** Economic considerations, especially the wealth and resources of the regions in the Dakshinapatha campaign, were significant factors in guiding Gupta military strategies.

Geographical Expansion:

- **North India (Group One):** Samudragupta first consolidated his power in the Ganga-Yamuna doab region by annexing several princely states through military conquests.
- **Eastern Himalayan States (Group Two):** He extended Gupta control to the eastern Himalayan states including Samatata, Davaka, Kamarupa, Nepala, and Kartripura. These regions were strategically important for their trade routes and resources.
- **Forest Kingdoms (Group Three):** The Vindhyan forest kingdoms, known as Atavika Rajyas, were also brought under Gupta suzerainty during his campaigns.
- **Deccan and South India (Group Four):** Samudragupta's Dakshinapatha campaign was particularly significant, where he conquered twelve states in the eastern Deccan and parts of South India. This campaign, termed as Moksha, aimed to liberate the local rulers from foreign influences and integrate them into the Gupta Empire. Cities like Avamukta, Dusthalapura, and various Pallava territories came under Gupta rule.
- **Foreign Invaders (Group Five):** Samudragupta also dealt decisively with foreign invaders like the Shakas and Kushanas, expelling them from Indian territories and restoring Gupta authority.

Samudragupta (335–375)



Chandragupta II (376 – 413/15)

Samudragupta-**Ramagupta-**Chandragupta II

Shaka Rudrasimha II- Ramagupta-humiliating treaty- wife

Killed-brother-Marry his Dhruvadevi

- ❑ Vikramaditya
- ❑ Kuberanaga (the Naga princess)
- ❑ Prabhavati-Rudrasena II-Vakataka
- ❑ After the death-Prabhavati-Regent

- ❑ Indirect control- Vakataka
- ❑ Malwa and Gujarat- Ujjain

***Navaratnas* (nine gems)**

Kalidasa
Amarasimha
Varahamihira
Dhanvantri
Ghatakarapara
Shanku
Kahapanaka
Vararuchi
Vetala Bhatta.

- Iron pillar- Mehrauli in Delhi
- *Vikramaditya*-Sun-*Simhavikrama*

- Silver & Copper coins
- Udaigiri cave inscriptions-D*igvijaya*

- Fa Hien (Record of the Buddhist Country)

Navaratna

Navaratna

1. Amarsimha: Amarsimha was a Sanskrit lexicographer and a poet and his Amarkosha is a vocabulary of Sanskrit roots, homonyms and synonyms. It is also called Trikanda as it has 3 parts viz. Kanda 1, Kanda 2 and Kanda 3. It has 10 thousand words in it.

2. Harisena: Harisena is known to have composed the Prayag Prasasti or Allahabad Pillar Inscription. The title of this inscription of Kavya, but it has both prose and verse. The whole poem is in one sentence including first 8 stanzas of poetry and a long sentence and a concluding stanza. Harisena in his old age was in the court of Chandragupta and describes him as Noble, and asks him "You Protect all this earth".

3. Kalidasa: Kalidasa is the immortal poet and playwright of India and a peerless genius whose works became famous worldwide in modern world. Translation of Kalidasa's works in numerous Indian and Foreign Languages have spread his fame all of the word and now he ranks among the top poets of all times.

4. Varahamihira: Varahamihira (died 587) lived in Ujjain and he wrote three important books: Panchasiddhantika, Brihat Samhita, and Brihat Jataka. The Panchasiddhantaka is a summary of five early astronomical systems including the Surya Siddhanta. Another system described by him, the Paitamaha Siddhanta, appears to have many similarities with the ancient Vedanga Jyotisha of Lagadha. Brihat Samhita is a compilataion of an assortment of topics that provides interesting details of the beliefs of those times. Brihat Jataka is a book on astrology which appears to be considerably influenced by Greek astrology.

5. Vararuchi: Vararuchi is the name of another gem of Chandragupta Vikramaditya who was a grammarian and Sanskrit scholar. Some historians have identified him with Katyayana. Vararuchi is said to be the author of Prakrit Prakasha, which is first Grammar of Prakrit Language.

6. Vetalbhatta: He is a magician.

7. Dhanvantri: Dhanvantri was a great Physician.

8. Kahapanaka: Kahapanka was an astrologer.

9. Sanku: Sanku was in the field of Architecture.

Chandragupta II not only expanded Gupta Empire but also was a great patron of literature. Comment

Kumaragupta I (415 – 455)

Shakraditya and *Mahendraditya*

*A*shavmedha sacrifice

Nalanda University

Lord *Karttikeya*

1. Y*e-tha*-White Huns (Hepthalites)-Oxus valley

Skandagupta

2. Pushyamitra (uncertain identity)

Inscriptions

Bilsad

Karandanda

Mandsor

Damodar Copper plate inscriptions

Skandagupta (455 – 467)

- Pushyamitra's problem?
- He faced and repulsed the Huns successfully.
- Junagarh/Girnar inscription
  - *Governor Parnadatta got the* Sudarshan Lake *repaired*.
- He adopted the title *Vikramaditya*.

Following Skandagupta's death (467), the empire was clearly in decline and the later Gupta coinage indicates their loss of control over much of western India after 467–469.

Purugupta (467–473)

Kumaragupta II (473–476)

Budhagupta (476-495)

Narasimhagupta (495–530)

Kumaragupta III (530–540)

Vishnugupta (540–550),

Vainyagupta

Bhanugupta.

Factors that Led to the Rise of the Gupta Empire

1. Strategic Matrimonial Alliances:

- Chandragupta I's Alliance: The Gupta Empire's ascent began with the marriage of Chandragupta I to Kumaradevi, a Licchavi princess. This alliance not only provided a significant political and territorial boost but also solidified the Gupta's standing among northern Indian dynasties .

- Chandragupta II's Alliances: Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya) further strengthened the empire through strategic marriages, such as his marriage to Kuberanaga, a Naga princess, and the marriage of his daughter, Prabhavatigupta, to a Vakataka prince. These alliances facilitated expansion and consolidation of power across India .

2. Military Prowess and Expansion:

- Samudragupta's Campaigns: Samudragupta, often referred to as the "Napoleon of India" by historian V.A. Smith, was instrumental in expanding the Gupta Empire through a combination of military conquests and diplomacy. His campaigns extended the empire's boundaries from the Himalayas in the north to the Narmada River in the south .

- Consolidation under Chandragupta II: Chandragupta II continued the expansionist policy, notably defeating the Western Kshatrapas and annexing Gujarat and Malwa, which brought valuable ports and trading opportunities under Gupta control .

3. Cultural and Economic Flourishing:

- Cultural Renaissance: The Gupta period saw a renaissance in arts, literature, and science. Figures like Kalidasa in literature and Aryabhata in astronomy and mathematics flourished under Gupta patronage, elevating the cultural prestige of the empire .

- Economic Prosperity: The Gupta Empire's control over key trade routes facilitated extensive commerce, both domestically and internationally, particularly with the Roman Empire and Southeast Asia, leading to economic prosperity and wealth accumulation .

4. Administrative Efficiency & Military Strength

- Decentralized Governance: The Gupta administration was marked by a relatively decentralized system where local rulers retained significant autonomy under the suzerainty of the Gupta emperor.

- Revenue and Land Management: Efficient land management and a robust tax system, supported by land grants to Brahmins and religious institutions, helped sustain the economic base of the empire and fostered agricultural productivity .

- Defensive Fortifications: The Guptas maintained a strong military and built fortifications along their frontiers to safeguard against invasions, notably by the Huns.

Factors that Led to the Fall of the Gupta Empire

1. Weak Successors and Administrative Decline:

- Post-Skandagupta Weakness: After the reign of Skandagupta, successive rulers were comparatively weak and lacked the administrative acumen and military prowess to maintain the empire's vast territories and political coherence. This led to internal fragmentation and a loss of central authority .
- Succession Issues: The lack of a clear law of succession often resulted in disputes and power struggles, weakening the central authority and leading to instability within the empire .

2. Neglect of Frontier Defense:

- Huna Invasions: The Gupta rulers' failure to adequately defend their northwestern frontiers led to repeated incursions by the Huns (Hephthalites). These invasions not only resulted in territorial losses but also inflicted significant economic and military strain on the empire .

3. Economic Challenges:

- Depletion of Treasury: Continuous military campaigns and the defense against invasions drained the empire's treasury. The resulting financial strain made it difficult to maintain administrative and military infrastructure, leading to economic decline and administrative inefficiency .
- Decline in Trade: Disruptions caused by invasions and internal instability negatively impacted trade routes, leading to economic stagnation. The decline in commerce further weakened the economic foundations of the empire .

4. Rise of Feudalism:

- Feudal Decentralization: The increasing practice of land grants to military officers and Brahmins (feudal lords) led to a decentralized feudal system. Over time, these local lords gained significant autonomy and power, undermining central authority and contributing to the empire's fragmentation .

5. Religious and Social Changes:

- Social Fragmentation: The rise of feudalism and the increasing autonomy of local lords contributed to social fragmentation. The once-unified social fabric under Gupta rule began to unravel, leading to the weakening of centralized control and cohesive governance .

6. Cultural and Political Fragmentation:

- Loss of Cohesion: The Gupta Empire's decline was marked by the loss of political cohesion and the emergence of regional powers. The erosion of centralized control and the rise of independent regional states further accelerated the disintegration of the empire .

Decline of the Gupta Empire

(i) Invasion by the Hunas

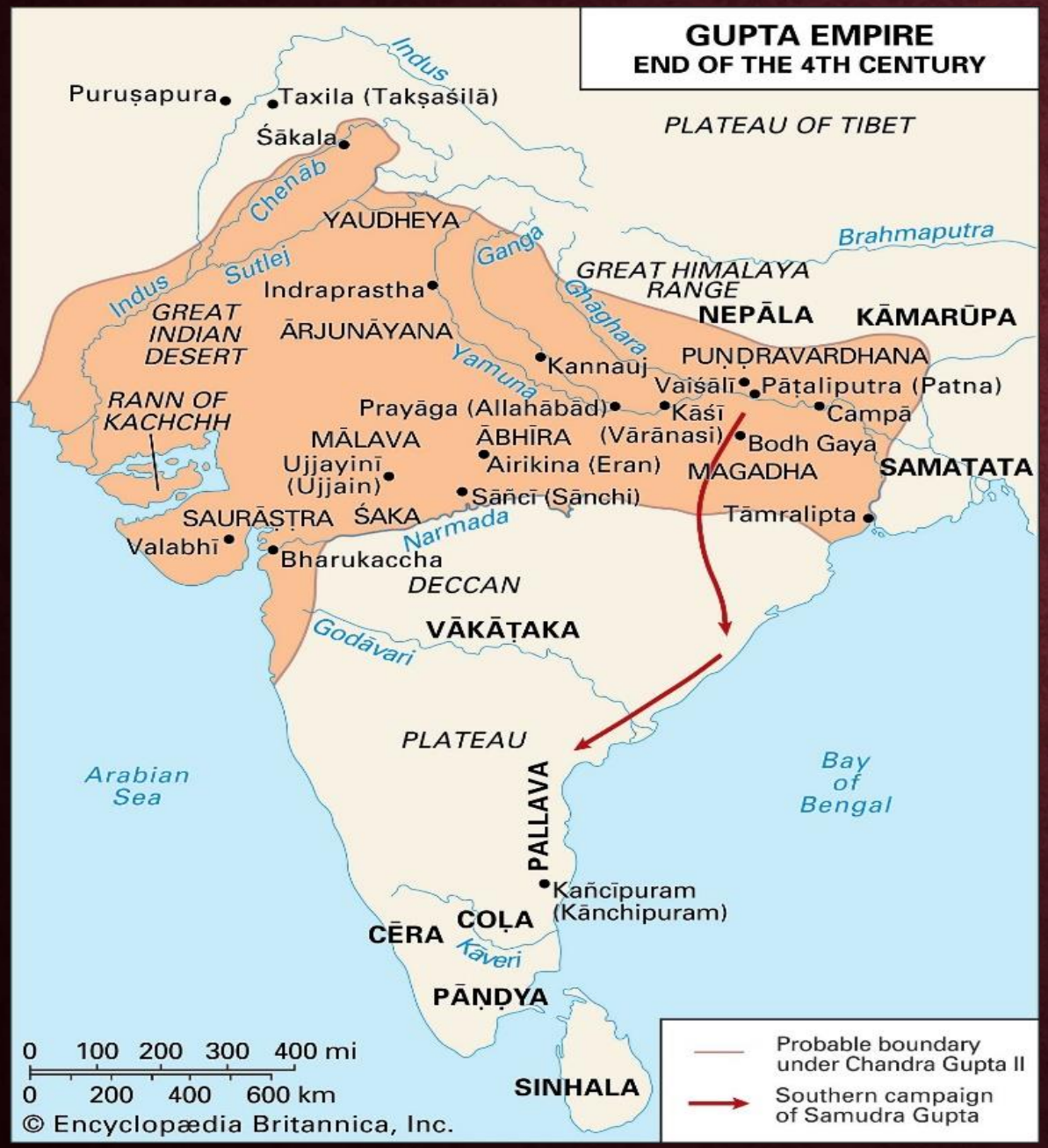
(ii) Rise in feudalism

(iii) Weak successors

(iv) Financial difficulties

(v) Decline of foreign trade

(vi) Absence of large professional army


GUPTA EMPIRE
END OF THE 4TH CENTURY
Puruṣapura
Taxila (Takṣaśilā)
Śākala
Indus
PLATEAU OF TIBET
Chenāb
YAUDHEYA
Sutlej
Ganga
Brahmaputra
GREAT HIMALAYA RANGE
Indraprastha
Indus
GREAT INDIAN DESERT
ĀRJUNĀYANA
Ghāghara
NEPĀLA
KĀMARŪPA
Yamuna
Kannauj
PUṆḌRAVARDHANA
Vaiśālī
Pāṭaliputra (Patna)
RANN OF KACHCHH
Prayāga (Allahābād)
Kāśī (Vārānasi)
Campā
MĀLAVA
ĀBHĪRA
Bodh Gaya
Ujjayinī (Ujjain)
Airikina (Eran)
MAGADHA
SAMATATA
Sāñcī (Sānchi)
SAURĀṢṬRA
ŚAKA
Tāmralipta
Narmada
Valabhī
Bharukaccha
DECCAN
VĀKĀṬAKA
Godāvari
PLATEAU
Arabian Sea
Bay of Bengal
PALLAVA
Kañcīpuram (Kānchipuram)
CĒRA
COḶA
Kāveri
PĀṆḌYA
SINHALA
0 100 200 300 400 mi
0 200 400 600 km
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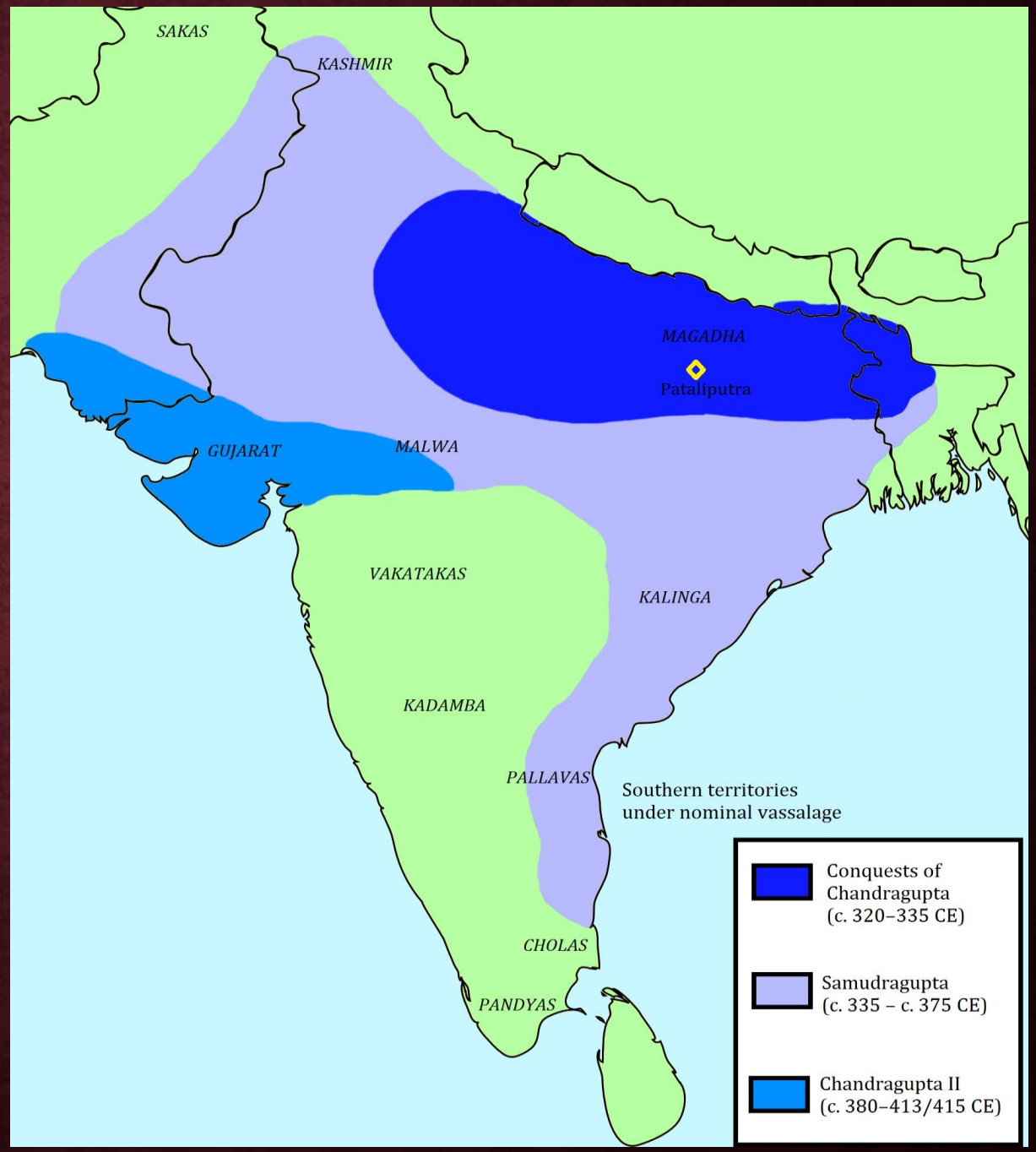
Probable boundary under Chandra Gupta II
Southern campaign of Samudra Gupta


SAKAS
KASHMIR
MAGADHA
Pataliputra
GUJARAT
MALWA
VAKATAKAS
KALINGA
KADAMBA
PALLAVAS
Southern territories under nominal vassalage
CHOLAS
PANDYAS
Conquests of Chandragupta (c. 320–335 CE)
Samudragupta (c. 335 – c. 375 CE)
Chandragupta II (c. 380–413/415 CE)

Gupta Administration

Title:-
Parameshavara
Maharajadhiraja
Vikramadiya
Paramabhattaraka

State

Divisions (*bhuktis*)-----*Uparika*

Districts (*vishayas*)-----*Vishyapati*

Kingship- hereditary
Absence Primogeniture
K*umaramatyas*

- Land taxes increased while those on trade and commerce decreased; land tax was between 1/4 to 1/6 of the produce.
- ***Visthi*** (Forced labour) prevailed. Religious functionaries were granted land called *Agrahara*.

Important Officials at the Central Level

Mahabaladhikrita	Commander-in-Chief
Mahadanayak	Chief justice
Mahapratihar	An official to maintain the royal palace.
Mahasandhivigrahak	An official for post-war concilation
Dandapashika	Head of the police department
Bhandagaradhikreta	Head of the royal treasury
Mahapaksha-Patalik	Head of the account department
Vinaysthitisansathapak	Head of the education department
Sarvadhyaksha	Inspector for the all central departments
Mahashwapati	Controller of cavalry
Mahamahipilapati	Controller and executor of elephantry
Vinaypura	Official to present different guests at king’s court
Yuktapurusha	Office to keep account of war booty
Khadyatpakika	Inspector of royal kitchen
Ranabhandagarika	Officer-in-charge of army stores
Mahanarpati	Head of foot soldiers (infantry)

Gupta Administration

34. Discuss the provincial and district administrative units of the Gupta Empire with the designations and functions of the officers. (2014)

Provincial Administration

1. Provinces (Deshas or Bhuktis):

- The Gupta Empire was divided into provinces for administrative purposes. These provinces were known as Deshas or Bhuktis.
- Each province was headed by a Kumaramatya, who served as the chief administrative officer responsible for the overall governance of the province.

2. Uparikas (Governors):

- Uparikas were appointed by the king to govern specific Bhuktis within the empire.
- They wielded both administrative and military authority, overseeing day-to-day governance, law enforcement, and defense within their assigned regions. Uparikas also played a crucial role in the maintenance and repair of infrastructure such as waterworks and roads.

District Administration

1. Districts (Vishyas):

- Each Bhukti was further divided into districts known as Vishyas.
- The Vishyas were headed by Vishyapatis, who were appointed by the provincial governor (Goptri).
- Vishyapatis were responsible for the administration of their respective districts, ensuring law and order, tax collection, and overall welfare of the local population.

2. Functions of District Officers:

- Nagara-Shreshthi: Chief merchant or banker responsible for overseeing trade and commerce within the district.
- Sarthavaha: Chief caravan trader who managed trade caravans passing through the district.
- Prathama-Kulika: Chief artisan in charge of promoting and regulating local craftsmanship and industries.
- Prathama Kyastha: Revenue collectors who collected taxes and maintained records of land revenue and other taxes.

3. Supporting Officers:

- Vithis: Assisted Vishyapatis in administrative and judicial matters, ensuring smooth functioning of district affairs.
- Gaulmikas: Assisted in local governance and public welfare activities, acting as intermediaries between the administration and the local communities.

Gupta: Revenue & Trade

- 18 types of taxes=== *Bhaga*
- Buffalo milk, curd and also on fruits and flowers.
- The forests, meadows and salt mines
- Ship-building industry
- *Tamralipti*, a port in Bengal===China, Ceylon, Java and Sumatra.
- *Tondai* was a famous port of Chola state
- Kalyana, Chol, Broach and Cambay were the important ports of the South.

Gupta Literature

Sanskrit

Prose and poetry, verses and drama

The Allahabad Pillar Inscription---- Harisena

Kalidasa--- *Shakuntalam, Malavikagnimitra* and *Vikramorvasiya*

Mahakavyas---- *Raghuvamsa* and *Kumarasambhava*

P*oem *Meghaduta

Philosophical literature

Hindus, Buddhists and Jains

Sankhya philosophy and also on Mimansa Sutra

Vatsayana===law

Gupta Literature

Kalidasa	Raghuwansa, Ritusamhara, Meghaduta, Vikramovarshiya, Malvikagnimitra and Abhijnanasakuntalam
Batsabhatti	Ravanabodha
Dandin	Kavyadarshana and Dasakumarcharita
Bharavi	Kiratarjuniyam
Bhartahari	Nitishataka
Sudaraka	Mrichchakatika
Bhasa	Swapnavasavadatta, Charudatta and Pratignayaugandharayana
Visakhadatta	Mudrarakshasa and Devichandraguptam
Harisena	Pryag-Prasasti
Ishwar Krishna	Sankhyakarika (base on Sankhya philosophy)
Prashastipada	Padartha Dharmasangraha
Acharya Vyasa	Vyasa Bhasya (based on Yoga philosophy)
Vatsyayana	Nyaya Bhasya (on Nyaya philosophy)
Religious Works	The Ramayana and the Mahabharata,
Amarsimha	Amarakosha
Chandragomin	Chandravyakarana
Dandin	Kavyadarsha
Vishnu Sharma	Panchatantra and Hitopadesha
Smritis	Vaynavalkyasmriti, Parasharsmriti, Brihspatismriti, Naradasmriti and Katyayanasmriti
Aryabhatta	Aryabhattiya, Dashjitikasutra
Varahmihira	Aryashtashata
Brahmagupta	Brhatsamhita, Panchasidhantika and Brahmasidhanata

Gupta Literature

1. Epic Poetry:

- **Kalidasa:** Kalidasa, the foremost poet of the Gupta Age, wrote epics like Raghuvamsham and Kumarasambhavam. These works exemplify elaborate poetic style, rich imagery, and profound philosophical insights, setting high standards for subsequent literary compositions.

2. Drama:

- **Kalidasa:** His plays such as Abhijnanasakuntalam, Malavikagnimitram, and Vikramorvashiyam are masterpieces that continue to influence Indian classical drama. They introduced complex characters, intricate plots, and lyrical dialogues, shaping the dramatic tradition for centuries.
- **Bhasa:** Another significant dramatist of the era, Bhasa's works like Swapnavasavadattam, Pratijna Yaugandharayana, and Pancharatra demonstrate a deep understanding of human emotions and societal values, contributing to the richness of Indian theatrical heritage.

3. Prose and Stories:

- **Dandin:** Known for his romantic tales in Dashakumaracharita, Dandin's prose narratives depicted courtly life and love with elegance and charm, setting a benchmark for storytelling in classical Sanskrit literature.
- **Vishnu Sharma:** Authored the timeless collection of animal fables in Panchatantra, teaching moral lessons through engaging narratives that have transcended cultural boundaries.

4. Treatises: **Kamandaka's Nitisara** provided practical guidance on statecraft and governance, reflecting the administrative sophistication of the Gupta Empire. **Vatsyayana's Kamasutra** stands as a comprehensive treatise on human relationships, addressing social conduct, eroticism, and the complexities of urban life in ancient India.

5. Poetics and Grammar: Dandin, Varahamihira, Amarasimha: Scholars like Dandin (Kavyadarsha), Varahamihira (Brihat Samhita), and Amarasimha (Amarakosha) made seminal contributions to poetics, astronomy, and lexicography respectively.

6. Philosophical Works: Vyasa, Dharmakirti: Philosophical works like Vyasa's commentaries and Dharmakirti's Nyayabindu contributed to the advancement of philosophical thought.

7. Inscriptions and Smriti Texts: Harisena: Inscriptions like those of Harisena, the court poet of Samudragupta, provide historical insights. **Manusmriti and Naradasmriti**, among others, codified social laws and norms, reflecting the legal and ethical frameworks of ancient Indian society.

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6. Philosophical Works: Vyasa, Dharmakirti: Philosophical works like Vyasa's commentaries and Dharmakirti's Nyayabindu contributed to the advancement of philosophical thought.

7. Inscriptions and Smriti Texts: Harisena: Inscriptions like those of Harisena, the court poet of Samudragupta, provide historical insights. **Manusmriti and Naradasmriti**, among others, codified social laws and norms, reflecting the legal and ethical frameworks of ancient Indian society.

Religion during Gupta Period

Hinduism

- **Worship of Trinity:** The Guptas popularized the worship of the Hindu trinity—Brahma (the creator), Vishnu (the preserver), and Shiva (the destroyer). This period saw the consolidation of Hindu practices and the codification of Hindu law.
- **Secular Approach:** Despite their promotion of Hinduism, the Guptas were secular rulers and supported various heterodox sects. They were tolerant of other religions and their practices.

Buddhism

- **Emergence of Vajrayana:** The Vajrayana sect of Buddhism emerged during this period, emphasizing the worship of Bodhisattvas and their consorts, Taras, as sources of spiritual energy and enlightenment.
- **Nalanda University:** Kumaragupta I established the renowned Nalanda University, which became a leading center of Buddhist learning and attracted scholars from across Asia.
- **Artistic Contributions:** A notable example is the two-meter bronze statue of Buddha found in Sultanganj, Bihar, showcasing the advanced metallurgical skills and religious art of the time.

Jainism

- **Second Jaina Council:** The Second Jaina Council was convened in Valabhi, which played a crucial role in the preservation and dissemination of Jain teachings.
- **Sectarian Developments:** The period saw the rise of the Digambara and Shwetambara sects, each with their own religious texts and interpretations.
- **Influence of Krishna:** Interestingly, Lord Krishna, a prominent figure in Hinduism, also gained recognition as a deity among the common people during this era.

Fine Arts during Gupta Period

The Gupta period witnessed a flourishing of fine arts, including architecture, sculpture, and painting, setting high standards for artistic expression.

- **Fresco Paintings:** Fresco painting, a technique that uses water-based pigments on freshly applied plaster, became popular. The Ajanta and Ellora caves are prime examples of Gupta fresco art, depicting intricate religious and secular themes.
- **Ajanta and Ellora Caves:** The caves feature exquisite paintings and sculptures that highlight the artistic and cultural richness of the Gupta era. These works are notable for their detail, color, and expression.
- **Temple Architecture:** The Guptas pioneered the construction of brick temples, such as:
  - The Dashavatara Temple in Deogarh, Jhansi, which is dedicated to Vishnu and is one of the earliest examples of North Indian temple architecture.
  - The Bhitargaon Temple, known for its impressive terracotta panels and intricate carvings.

Dasavatar Temple, at Deogarh (MP)

Maniyar Math, Rajgir

Sanchi (MP)

Bagh Caves (MP)

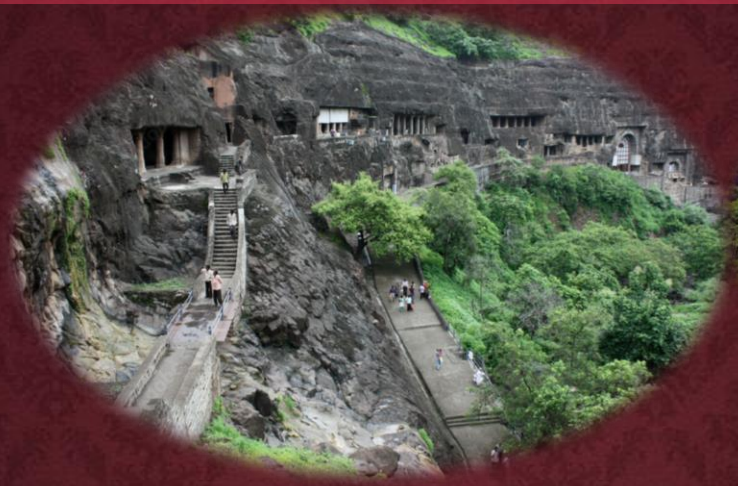
- These caves are nine **rock-cut monuments located about a hundred miles north of Ajanta in Madhya Pradesh.**
- All the caves are **Vihara**, and only five of the nine caves have survived. **Rang Mahal Cave** is the most well-known cave
- These caves are **known for their mural paintings (Wall paintings)**, such as a procession of elephants and a scene of a dancer and woman musicians depicted on the walls of a cave's veranda.

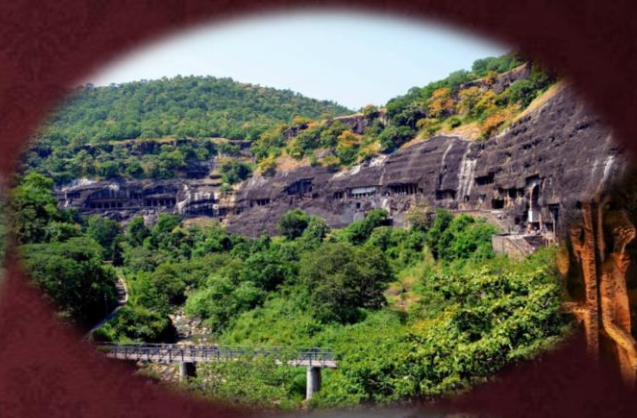
Paintings at Bagh Caves

Ajanta Caves (Aurangabad, Maharashtra)

29 caves (all Buddhist)
25- Viharas
4- Chaitya

200 B.C. to 650 A.D.
Satavahana
Vakataka kings – Harishena





fresco painting
Naturalism
Colours: vegetation and minerals
Red Colour: A**bsence of blue colour**

FRESCO: A technique of mural painting executed upon freshly laid or wet lime plaster. It is closely associated with Italian Renaissance painting.

The Dying Princess, Ajanta (Cave 16)

Science & Technology During Gupta

Mathematics

- Aryabhata
- *Aryabhatiya*
- Inscription of Allahabad== decimal system
- (Aryabhatt-first)
- Astronomy---*Romaka Sidhanta*
- Finding out the area of triangle==*Trigonometry*
- Calculated the value of **pie (π)**
- Algebra
- Brahmagupta===algebra to astronomical problems

Astronomy

Aryabhatta and *Varahmihir*

Aryabhatta== Find out the cause of lunar and solar eclipses;
calculated the circumference of earth;
was first to reveal that the sun is stationary
the earth revolved round the sun.

Varahamihir---*Brihatsamhita* and *Panch Sidhhantika*.
Brahmagupta--- *Brahma Sphutic Siddhata*--- law of gravitation.

Major contributions

Notational system
Decimal system
Use of zero.

Medicine

Sushruta and *Charak*
The *Sushruta Samhita*==operating cataracts, stone diseases
Charaka===Father of Indian Medicine
Vrihad Vagabhatta===Astanghridaya

Metallurgy

Iron and bronze Images
Iron pillar (Mehrauli)

Chandragupta II & *Kumaragupta*

Vakataka Kingdom

- They were great champions of the Brahmanical religion and performed several Vedic sacrifices.
- Culturally, they became a channel for transmitting Brahmanical ideas and social institutions to the south.
- The founder of this dynasty was **Vidya Shakti** but his son **Pravarsena** could be its real founder in western and central India.
- In the 5th century A.D., Vakatakas extended their power in Malwa. **Harisena** was the last important monarch controlling all the central Deccan.
- They were uprooted by the growing power of **Chalukyas** of Badami, **Pallavas** of Kanchipuram and **Pandyyas** of Madurai.

- The Vakatakas had matrimonial ties with the imperial Guptas (Rudrasena II was married to Prabhavatigupta, the daughter of Chandragupta II), the Nagas of Padmavati, the Kadambas of Karnataka, and the Vishnukundins of Andhra.
- The rock-cut Buddhist *vihara*s and *chaitya*s of the Ajanta Caves were built under the patronage of the Vakataka king, Harisena.
- They are also credited with having built a few temples in Tigwa and Nachanakuthara. They made a remarkable contribution in the field of paintin

Vindhyashakti I (Around 250-270) founded the Vakataka dynasty, who probably ruled from Purika. The Ajanta Inscriptions of the time of Harisena describes him as a *dvija* and praises him for his military achievements. It is claimed:

"the sun was obscured by the masses of dust raised by his horses' hooves, and he is compared with the gods Puramdara (Indra) and Upendra (Vishnu)."

- He extended the empire southwards into Vidarbha and adjoining areas of the Deccan, with his capital at Kanchanaka (modern Nachna).
- His son Gautamiputra married the daughter of the Naga king Bhavanaga, which cemented an important political alliance.
- By military exploits and matrimonial alliances, he extended his kingdom from Bundelkhand in the north to Hyderabad in the south, and to commemorate his victories, he performed an *asvamedha* sacrifice and a *vajapeya* sacrifice.
- He was the only Vakataka king who took the title of *samrat*, while all other kings took the modest title of maharaja.
- After the death of Pravarasena, his four sons divided the empire and ruled independently in separate provinces.
- Gautamiputra in all likelihood died during the lifetime of his father and hence, his son Rudrasena I succeeded his grandfather Pravarsena to the throne and ruled from Nandivardhana, near modern Nagpur.
- Sarvasena, another son of Pravarasena, started ruling independently from Vastugulma as his capital, which is identified as modern Bassien in Vidarbha.

Nandivarman Branch

- **Rudrasena I** (340-365): He was the founder of the Vakataka Nandivardhana branch, which ruled from Nandivardhana (near Nagpur).
  - He is known to have been a worshipper of Lord *Mahabhairava*, the fierce form of Shiva.
- **Prithvisena I** (365–390): Described in later Vakataka inscriptions as a righteous conqueror, he was compared to the epic hero Yudhishthira due to his comparable qualities of truthfulness, transparency, compassion, and humility.
  - Padmapura seems to have been an important administrative centre during his time.
  - During the later parts of his reign, the Guptas and the Vakatakas entered into a matrimonial alliance since Prithvisena's son Rudrasena II, the crown prince, was married to Prabhavatigupta, the daughter of Chandragupta II.
  - Prithivisena also was a Shaiva like his father.
- **Rudrasena II** (390–395): Ruled only for a period of five years as he died prematurely, leaving behind three minor sons Divakarasena, Damodarasena, and Pravarasena.
  - His wife Prabhavatigupta ruled as the regent until 410. *Unfortunately*, Divakarasena also died prematurely and did not live long enough to ascend the throne but his younger brothers Damodarasena and Pravavarasena II did.
  - In fact, the seal of Prabhavatigupta's Maregaon plates describes her as the '*mother of two kings*.'
- **Pravarasena II** (395 – 440). Largest number of Vakataka inscriptions belong to his reign.
  - He is credited with the founding of a new capital at Pravarapura, which is identified as Paunar in the presentday Wardha district.
  - Even though he was a devotee of Shiva, he composed a Prakrit *kavya* glorifying Rama, the *Setubandha*/*Ravanavaha*.
  - He entered into a matrimonial alliance with the contemporary Kadambas (near Mysore).
  - His son Narendrasena was married to a princess of Kuntala, Ajihata Bhattarika, the daughter of Kakutsavarman of the Kadamba dynasty.

Nandivarman Branch

- **Narendrasena** (440 – 460): It is believed that after the death of Pravarsena II, a struggle for succession happened in which Narendrasena emerged successful.
- He had to face the invasion of the Nala king, Bhavadottavarman, both in the beginning and at the end of his reign.
- In between, he made some conquests, and had to face the stiff opposition of the Nalas all along.

- **Prithivisena II** (460 – 480) is the last known ruler of the Nandivardhana branch of the Vakataka dynasty, who is credited with the revival of the fallen fortunes of the Vakatakas.
- His inscriptions refer to his *having twice rescued the sunken fortunes of Vakatakas*.
- He had to face the invasion of Harisena of Vatsagulma line thrice, and the invasion of Bhavadottavarman of the Nala dynasty.
- He also appears to have fought with the Traikutaka king, Dahrasena of southern Gujarat.
- After Prithivisena II's death, it is presumed that Harisena of the Vatsagulma line of the Vakatakas conquered his successors and united the Nandivardhana line with his own.

Vastagulma Branch

- Capital: Vatsagulma (modern Washim in Akola district, Maharashtra).
- The founder *of the* Vatsagulma line of the Vakatakas was Sarvasena, the son of Pravarasena I.

Sarvasena (330 – 355)

- He adopted the title *dharma-maharaja* and was believed to be a renowned Prakrit poet, and his lost work, the *Harivijaya*, was lauded by later writers.
- Some of his verses were incorporated into the *Gathasattasai*.

Vindhyashakti II/Vindhyasena (355 – 400)

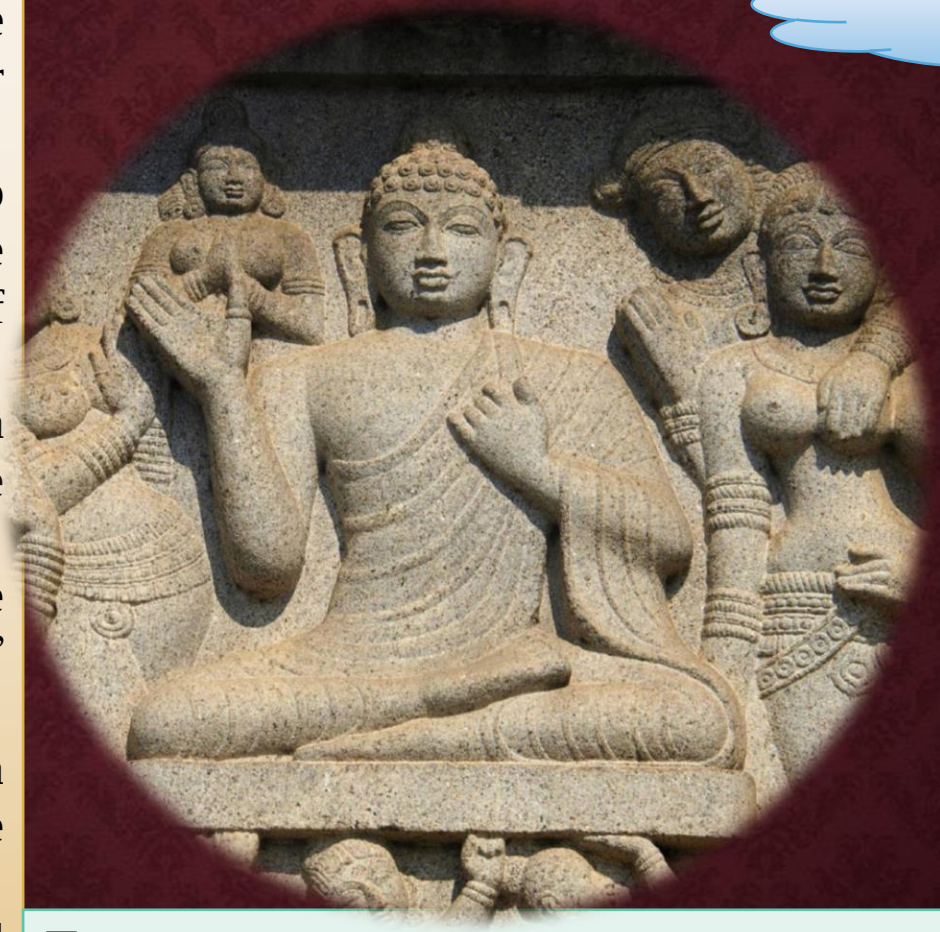
- He ruled for almost four decades. He is believed to have defeated the Kadambas of Banavasi, who ruled over Kuntala (north Karnataka).
- His son and successor **Pravarasena II** appear to have ruled for a period of fifteen years.
- Pravarasena II was followed by **Devasena**, who was a pleasure-seeking ruler, but luckily had the services of a very capable minister, **Hasthibhoja**.

Harisena (475 – 500)

- The last known king of the Vatsagulma line, who not only **united** the two Vakataka branches but also extended his territories by **conquering** Kuntala, Avanti, Kalinga, Kosala, Konkan, and Andhra.
- His kingdom extended from Malwa in the north to southern Maharashtra in the south, and from the Bay of Bengal in the east to the Arabian Sea in the west.
- Dandin, a poet of the 6th century CE, described Harisena as "*powerful, truthful and bountiful, glorious, lofty, and a penetrating critic of ethical and economic compendia*".
- The Thalner copper plates (which record the gifts of villages of bronze workers and goldsmiths) belong to his reign and many of the Ajanta caves were executed during his reign.
- In one of the inscriptions at Cave XVI and the Ghatotkacha cave, there is mention of his minister Varahadeva.
- With the death of Harisena II, the glory of the Vakatakas ended and the Nalas, the Kadambas, the Kalachuris, and Yasodharman of Malwa occupied their territory.

Ikshavakus

- On the decline of the Satvahana power in the eastern part of the peninsula there arose the Ikshavakus in the Krishna Guntur region.
- They seem to have been a local tribe who adopted the dignified name of the Ikshavakus in order to show the antiquity of their lineage.
- A record of the Vijayapuri king **Ehuvala Chamtamula** traces his ancestry to the legendary Ikshvakus.
- The Ikshvakus of Vijayapuri seems to be the same as the 'Shriparvatiya Andhras' mentioned in the Matsya Purana.
- The dynasty's founder **Vasishthiputra Chamtamula** rose to power after the decline of the Satavahana power.
- He is attested by the Rentala and Kesanapalli inscriptions. The records of the later Ikshvaku kings describe Chamtamula as a great performer of the Vedic sacrifices such as **Agnishtoma**, **Vajapeya and Ashvamedha**.



- He was succeeded by his son **Virapurushadatta**.
- The Ikshvaku kings were Shaivites and performed Vedic rites, but Buddhism also flourished during their reign.
- Several Ikshvaku queens and princes contributed to the construction of the Buddhist monuments at present-day **Nagarjunakonda**.
- They were overthrown by the Pallavas.

Which river is praised in the 5th-century Tamil epic, Silappadikaram? (CDS II, 2017)

(a) Cauvery

(c) Saraswati

(b) Godavari

(d) Ganges

With reference to Indian history, the ‘Yavana’ refers to which of the following

1. Nedunjeral Adan, Chera king, captured Yavan and released them only after taking ransom.
2. Indo-Greek people were known as Yavan in India.
3. Modern Indian literature refers to Yavan as any foreign invaders including Muslims and Europeans.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only 1
(b) Only 2
(c) Only 3
(d) All